



## 2.7

## Composition of Functions

### Core-to-Challenge Worksheet and AP Practice

AP Precalculus - Unit 2

| ECHS Mathematics

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#### Student Information

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Class: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

#### Directions

Show mathematical evidence. Retain domain restrictions, label graphs, include units, and write complete interpretations. Calculator use is permitted only when the item explicitly requires approximation, regression, or numerical solving.

#### Readiness

1. Write one precise sentence explaining this principle: Composition order matters: generally  $f \circ g \neq g \circ f$ .  
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2. Write one precise sentence explaining this principle: The domain of  $f \circ g$  consists of inputs in the domain of  $g$  whose outputs lie in the domain of  $f$ .  
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3. Write one precise sentence explaining this principle: Units can reveal meaningful composition order.  
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4. Write one precise sentence explaining this principle: Decomposition is not always unique.  
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#### Core

5. Let  $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$  and  $g(x) = x - 5$ . Find  $f \circ g$  and its domain.  
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6. For  $f(x) = 2x + 1$ ,  $g(x) = x^2$ , compare  $f \circ g$  and  $g \circ f$ .

7. Decompose  $h(x) = \ln(3x^2 + 1)$ .

8. State what the formula  $(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$  tells you and name any required restriction.

9. State what the formula  $\text{Dom}(f \circ g) = \{x \in \text{Dom}(g) : g(x) \in \text{Dom}(f)\}$  tells you and name any required restriction.

10. Create a second representation (table, graph, formula, or context) for one central relationship in Composition of Functions. State its domain and justify one key feature.

### Medium

11. Given  $f(x) = 2x + 3$ ,  $g(x) = x^2$ , compute the indicated natural compositions and domains.

12. Given  $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$ ,  $g(x) = x - 4$ , compute the indicated natural compositions and domains.

13. Given  $f(x) = 1/x$ ,  $g(x) = x + 2$ , compute the indicated natural compositions and domains.

14. Given  $f(x) = \ln x$ ,  $g(x) = x^2 + 1$ , compute the indicated natural compositions and domains.

15. Given  $f(x) = x^3$ ,  $g(x) = \sqrt[3]{x-1}$ , compute the indicated natural compositions and domains.

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**Hard**

16. Find domain of  $\sqrt{\frac{1}{x-2}}$ . Interpret as a composition.

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17. Let  $f$  convert Celsius to Fahrenheit and  $g$  convert Fahrenheit to Kelvin. Which composition converts Celsius to Kelvin?

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18. Decompose  $h(x) = \sqrt{5-3x^2}$  in two different ways.

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19. Find  $f$  if  $f(g(x)) = 9x^2 + 6x + 2$  and  $g(x) = 3x + 1$ .

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**Difficult**

20. Find domain of  $\ln(\sqrt{x-1} - 2)$ .

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21. Find all linear  $f, g$  with  $f \circ g(x) = 6x + 5$ , giving one infinite family.

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22. Can  $f \circ g$  be one-to-one if  $g$  is not one-to-one? Prove.

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### Challenge / HOT

23. Can  $f \circ g$  be constant while both  $f$  and  $g$  are nonconstant? Construct an example.

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24. Prove composition is associative.

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### AP-Style Multiple Choice

25.  $(f \circ g)(x)$  means  
 (A)  $g(f(x))$   
 (B)  $f(g(x))$   
 (C)  $f(x)g(x)$   
 (D)  $f(x)+g(x)$
26. Composition is generally  
 (A) commutative

- (B) not commutative
  - (C) undefined always
  - (D) linear
27. Domain of  $f \circ g$  requires
- (A)  $x$  in  $f$  only
  - (B)  $x$  in  $g$  and  $g(x)$  in  $f$ -domain
  - (C) all real  $x$
  - (D)  $f(x)=g(x)$
28. If  $f(x)=x+1, g(x)=2x$ , then  $f \circ g$  is
- (A)  $2x+1$
  - (B)  $2x+2$
  - (C)  $x+3$
  - (D)  $2x^2$
29. Outer function in  $\sqrt{3x+1}$  can be
- (A)  $u \mapsto \sqrt{u}$
  - (B)  $x \mapsto 3x+1$
  - (C)  $x \mapsto x^2$
  - (D)  $u \mapsto 1/u$
30. Units help determine
- (A) composition order
  - (B) polynomial degree only
  - (C) complex zeros
  - (D) asymptote sign

### AP-Style Free Response

31. Let  $f(x) = \sqrt{x-1}$  and  $g(x) = \frac{1}{x-2}$ . (a) Find  $f \circ g$  and domain. (b) Find  $g \circ f$  and domain. (c) Explain why they differ.

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32. A product is priced in euros by  $p(q)$ , then converted to QAR by  $c(e)$ , then taxed by  $t(r)$ . Write total function, interpret units at each stage, and state domain requirements.

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**Reflection**

Identify one item where a domain restriction, unit, assumption, or representation changed your reasoning. Explain in 2-3 sentences.

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Original ECHS questions. Selected concepts are informed by Pearson and Holt Precalculus; no textbook exercises are reproduced.